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Austin Hatch



Two-time plane crash survivor, former Michigan basketball player and keynote speaker on overcoming adversity.

Michigan · From Fort Wayne, Indiana · Keynotes for companies, sales teams, schools, churches and athletic programs, in person or virtual

#KeynoteSpeaker #OvercomingAdversity #Resilience #GRIT #GrowthMindset #Teamwork #Leadership #MichiganBasketball

- Overcoming adversity
- Grit and resilience
- Growth mindset
- Integrity and follow-through
- Team-first leadership
- Adapting to sudden change
- Finding your purpose

At a glance

Austin Hatch survived two plane crashes, eight years apart, that took his parents and siblings. After the second, in 2011, he spent two months in a coma and relearned how to walk, talk and eat, then went on to play basketball at the University of Michigan on the scholarship it had honored through his recovery. After graduating he worked in Domino's corporate office before turning to speaking full time. His Overcome It keynote teaches the G.R.I.T. framework (growth mindset, resilience, integrity and a team-first mentality) to companies, sales teams, schools and athletic programs.

2×
Plane crash survivor, in 2003 and 2011

Michigan
Full basketball scholarship, honored through his recovery

2 titles
Part of two Big Ten Tournament championship teams

G.R.I.T.
His framework for overcoming adversity

200+
Media appearances

Domino's
Former corporate team member

As seen in **ESPN · Parkview Sports Network · Bleacher Report · ABC · NBC Los Angeles · WOOD Radio**

Teams Austin has spoken for

Domino's · Nestlé · Northwestern Mutual · MassMutual · Bernstein · loanDepot · FirstService Residential · Farm Bureau Insurance · Purdue Basketball · Parkview Health

Keynotes & workshops

Overcome It

The G.R.I.T. framework of growth mindset, resilience, integrity and a team-first mentality, for turning adversity into opportunity.

Keynote, in person or virtual

The Secret

Why some people and teams overcome adversity and others don't, and how a greater purpose drives grit.

Keynote

Team First

Leading by example, following through on commitments and doing common things in an uncommon way.

Keynote for companies and sales teams

Overcome It for Students and Athletes

Grit, resilience and responding to setbacks, for schools, churches and athletic programs.

Keynote or school assembly

Who it's for

- Corporate leaders and teams
- sales and financial services teams
- schools and student-athletes
- churches
- athletic programs
- healthcare organizations

About Austin

Austin Hatch grew up in Fort Wayne, Indiana. In 2003, at age 8, he survived a plane crash that killed his mother, sister and brother. His father later remarried, and the blended family gave him a sense of normal life again. As a sophomore he led Canterbury High School to its first sectional title and was named The News-Sentinel's Prep Player of the Year. On June 15, 2011, Michigan's John Beilein offered him a full scholarship to his mother's alma mater. Nine days later a second crash, in Charlevoix, Michigan, killed his father and stepmother and left him in a medically induced coma for about two months. He relearned how to walk, talk and eat, signed with Michigan in 2013, scored his only college point on a free throw in December 2014 and spent two more seasons as an undergraduate assistant coach. After graduating he worked in Domino's corporate office, then built the G.R.I.T. framework he now teaches to organizations across the country. He lives in Michigan with his wife, Abby, a former

All-America volleyball player at Michigan, and their two children.

Track record

- Survived a 2003 plane crash in Wells County, Indiana, at age 8, and a 2011 crash in Charlevoix, Michigan
- Spent about two months in a medically induced coma and relearned how to walk, talk and eat
- Led Canterbury High School to its first sectional championship (2010–11); News-Sentinel Prep Sports Player of the Year and All-State Honorable Mention
- Offered a full University of Michigan basketball scholarship by John Beilein on June 15, 2011; Michigan honored it through his recovery and he signed in 2013
- Michigan men's basketball: player, then two seasons as an undergraduate assistant coach; part of two Big Ten Tournament championship teams and an NCAA national runner-up team
- Scored his only college point on a free throw, December 23, 2014
- University of Michigan graduate
- Worked in Domino's corporate office after graduating
- Creator of the G.R.I.T. framework: Growth mindset, Resilience, Integrity, Team-first mentality
- 200+ media appearances
- Spoken for teams including Domino's, Nestlé, Northwestern Mutual, MassMutual, Bernstein, loanDepot, FirstService Residential, Farm Bureau Insurance in Michigan and Purdue Men's Basketball

Stages

- Parkview Sports Medicine, Fort Wayne (Nov 2025): student-athletes from 14 high schools, the University of Saint Francis and Indiana Tech
- Parkview Health leadership, Parkview Mirro Center, Fort Wayne (Nov 2025)
- Connect Texas team, Dallas
- Schools, corporations and community groups across the country with the Overcome It talk

What people say

> “There's no one who has a testimony like his.” — LaVall Jordan, head men's basketball coach

Press, interviews & podcasts

ESPN

Michigan's Austin Hatch survived two plane crashes

Parkview Sports Network

Overcome It, Austin Hatch gives inspirational talk to local students (2025)

Bleacher Report

Survivor of 2 plane crashes to play college hoops at Michigan

ABC

Austin Hatch to take medical scholarship, retain full scholarship at Michigan

NBC Los Angeles

After tragedies, Austin Hatch heals with hoops

WOOD Radio

Former U of M athlete uses tragedy to inspire local students (2020)

Companies

Overcome It

his G.R.I.T. keynote and framework

How we can work together

Looking for

- Paid keynotes and sales kickoffs
- School, church and athletic program talks

Can offer

- The G.R.I.T. framework for teams and students
- A story of faith, family and resilience

Find Austin online

Website | LinkedIn | X (Twitter) | Podcast episodes on Spotify | Overcome It

Book Austin

Booking is handled by V Formation Consulting. Contact the agent for availability, format and fees.

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Sources

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